

Use Case Feasibility Checklist AIM ASEAN Programme:

AI for MSME Advancement in ASEAN

Curriculum Designed and Developed by:
AIM ASEAN Programme

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Checklist: Is Your Business Case Suitable for AI?

Use this checklist to help you evaluate if a specific business problem or opportunity is a good candidate for an AI solution.

There is a use case if you answer “Yes” to at least 12 out of the 14 questions. Tick them off if it’s a “Yes”.

1. Problem & Goal Definition

[] Do you have a clearly defined problem that AI would solve, and is it a high-priority business challenge?

[] Can you articulate a specific, measurable goal for the AI project (e.g., reduce customer support calls by 20%, increase sales leads by 10%)?

[] Is the problem repetitive, or does it involve analyzing large amounts of data that would be difficult for a human to process?

Tips:

- **Quantify the Problem:** Do not just state a problem; quantify it with specific metrics. Instead of saying "our customer support is slow," state "our average customer support ticket resolution time is 48 hours, costing us an estimated \$X per month in labor." This gives you a clear baseline to measure against.
- **Define a Specific, Measurable Goal:** Establish a **SMART** (Specific, Measurable, Attainable, Relevant, and Time-bound) goal for the project. For example, your goal should be "to reduce customer support ticket resolution time by 25% within six months using an AI chatbot." This provides a clear target and a timeline.
- **Identify the AI Output:** Be precise about what you need the AI to do. Is it a prediction (e.g., predicting customer churn), a classification (e.g., sorting customer emails), or a generation (e.g., creating product descriptions)? This helps in scoping the project and selecting the right model type.

2. Data Readiness

- [] Do you have access to a sufficient amount of relevant data (e.g., historical sales, customer feedback, operational logs)?
- [] Is the data in a structured, consistent format, or can it be easily organized?
- [] Is the data high-quality, reliable, and free from significant bias?
- [] Can the current data answer the problem or solve the challenge?

Tips:

- **Audit Your Data Quality:** Go beyond a simple yes/no check. Conduct a thorough audit of your data's completeness, accuracy, consistency, and uniqueness. If the data is incomplete or has significant errors, your first step is a data cleaning project, not an AI model build.
- **Plan Your Data Strategy:** If your data is siloed, create a plan to centralize it. If your data is not in a usable format, allocate resources for data engineering. If you lack sufficient labeled data, create a labeling plan and budget for human resources to perform this task. Remember, "garbage in, garbage out" is a fundamental truth in AI.
- **Establish Data Governance:** Define clear ownership for the data. Determine who is responsible for its ongoing maintenance, security, and integrity. This ensures the model's performance doesn't degrade due to stale or corrupted data in the future.

3. Feasibility & Resources

- [] Is there clear leadership buy-in and a willingness to invest time and resources into the project?
- [] Do you have the necessary budget and team to either implement an off-the-shelf AI tool or work with an external partner?
- [] Do you have the necessary budget and team to maintain an off-the-shelf AI tool or continue to liaise with an external partner?
- [] Are there existing, commercially available AI tools that could solve this problem, or would a custom solution be required?

Tips:

- **Securing stakeholder buy-in:** This is a critical step for any AI project. To achieve this, follow a simple three-step action plan. First, build a compelling business case that translates the AI project into clear, quantifiable business outcomes such as increased revenue or reduced costs. Second, be transparent and proactive by openly discussing

potential risks and limitations, which builds trust and credibility. Finally, plan to communicate progress consistently by providing regular updates on key milestones and early wins to keep stakeholders engaged and reinforce the project's value.

- **Conduct a Technical Feasibility Study:** Before committing, perform a small-scale proof of concept (PoC). This low-cost exercise will help you determine if the problem can be solved with AI given your available data and technical resources. You may find that the data is not predictive enough to solve the problem, saving you from a larger, failed investment.
- **Secure the Right Talent:** An AI project is not a single person's job. You need a cross-functional team that includes data scientists, data engineers, and a domain expert who understands the business problem. If you don't have this in-house, plan to hire or consult external experts.
- **Create a Realistic Budget:** AI projects are not just about the cost of the model. Your budget should account for data acquisition, data storage, cloud computing expenses (for training and running the model), and ongoing maintenance and monitoring costs.

4. Impact & Outcome

[] If successful, would the AI project have a significant, positive impact on your business (e.g., cost savings, revenue growth, competitive advantage)?

[] Will the AI solution augment your employees' capabilities rather than simply replacing them, allowing them to focus on more strategic tasks?

[] Do you have a plan to measure the success of the AI project and its return on investment (ROI)?

Tips:

- **Define Success Metrics:** Align your AI project's metrics with your business goals from Section 1. If your goal is to reduce costs, your success metric should be a specific cost-saving number. If it's about customer satisfaction, track NPS (Net Promoter Score) or CSAT (Customer Satisfaction) scores.
- **Plan for Change Management:** AI implementation is as much a human project as it is a technical one. Involve the employees whose jobs will be affected and train them on how to use and trust the new AI system. A project can fail not because the technology is bad, but because employees don't adopt it.
- **Establish a Monitoring Framework:** Your job is not done once the model is deployed. Set up a system to continuously monitor the model's performance and data quality. Plan for when the model needs to be retrained or updated to ensure it remains relevant and effective. This will allow the project to deliver value over the long term.